

State Review Learnings:

Lyon College

Traditional Route

On-Site Review: November 12-13, 2025

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two

BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two
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Lyon College

Traditional Route

Overall Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
MEETS	MEETS	APPROACHING

Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion

Standard 1 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	APPROACHING	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: Recruiting additional candidates to increase enrollment in subject shortage areas will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 1.2a, 1.2b</i>)		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	Lyon's Annual Plan presents a small program with the potential for growth as they systematically look at areas for expansion within their region and the state.

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	5.3%	MEETS

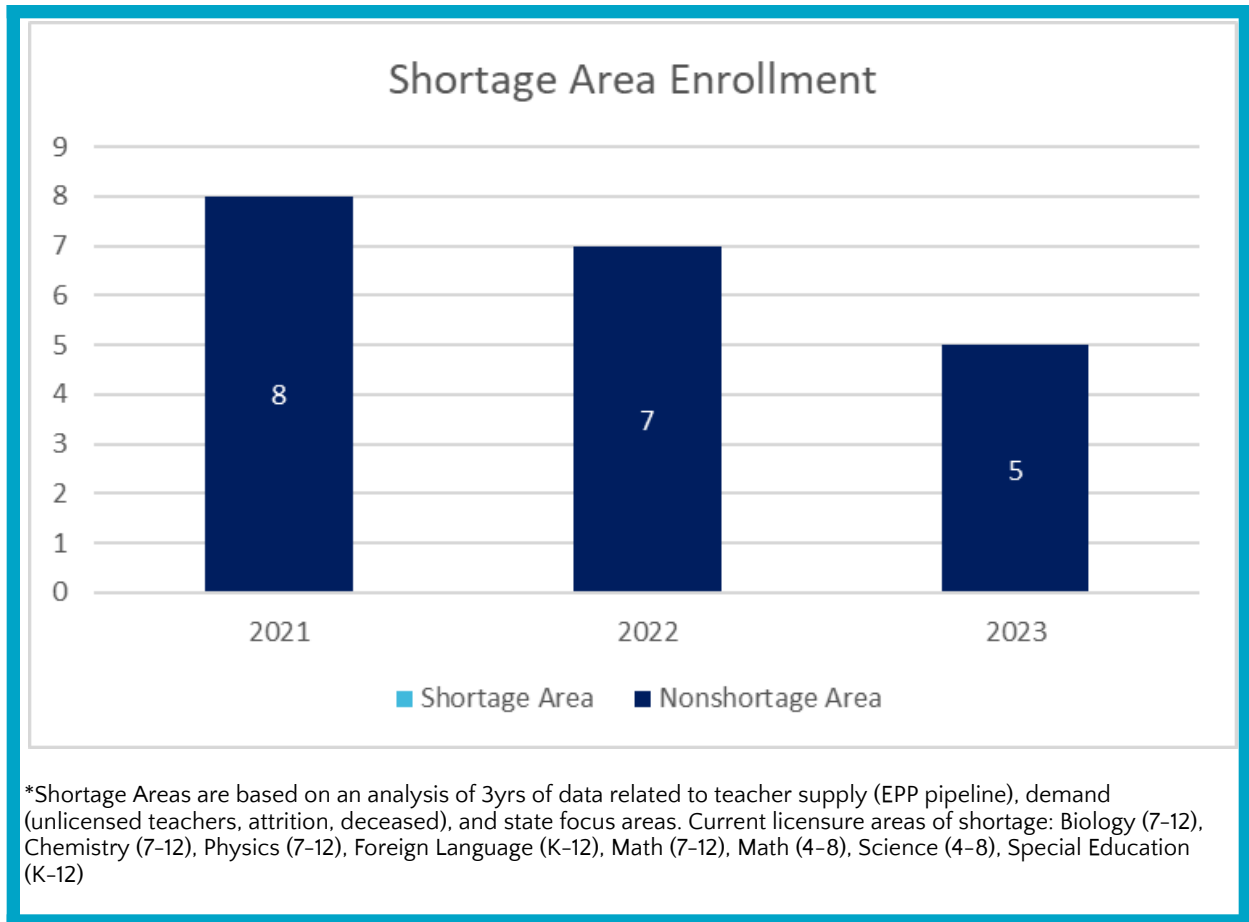
Enrollment

Metric is the percentage growth between blue and green boxes.

Year	Percentage Growth
2018	5
2019	5
2020	9
2021	8
2022	7
2023	5

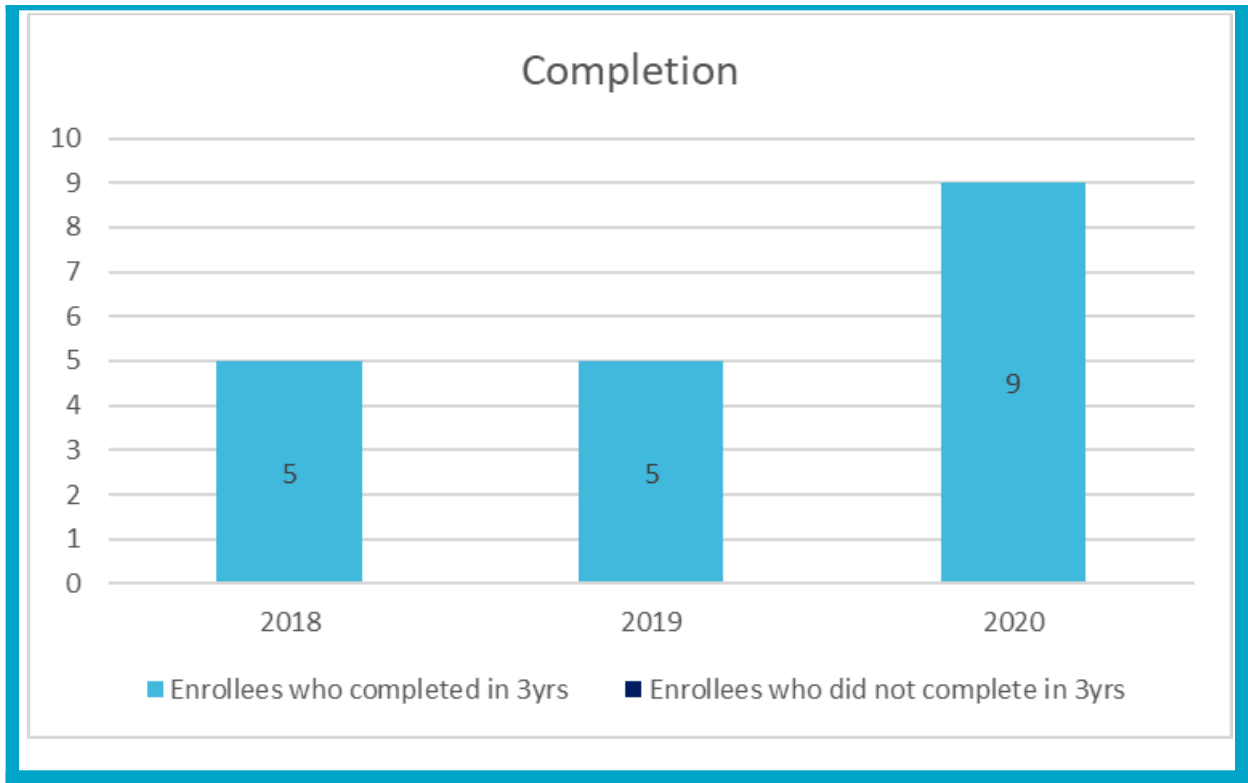
*The enrollment growth target was established with the aim of closing the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a "Meets" rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an "Exceeds" rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.

Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of New Enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	0%	BELOW



INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	100%	EXCEEDS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	MEETS	APPROACHING
Recommendations		
Lyon College's program prepares candidates to be day-one ready teachers. Candidates highlighted the support they receive from instructors, supervisors, mentor teachers and partner schools. The coursework is aligned with clinical experience, and teaching candidates have opportunities to reflect on the alignment with their instructors and clinical supervisors. Lyon college is well regarded by partner schools and works collaboratively to support candidates. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: - Audit coursework for classroom connections, ensuring that high-quality instructional materials are intentionally incorporated across all courses. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 2.1a Metric 1)</i> - Build or continue to revise a clear and intentional internship experience which includes opportunities for candidates to work with a variety of students with varied learning needs. Ensure candidates recognize the importance of applying methods to assess student work, including collecting data and showing evidence of impacting student growth. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 2.2a Metric 2, 2.3b Metric 2)</i>		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based APPROACHING
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction APPROACHING Coursework incorporates nationally recognized best practices in content instruction. Syllabi highlight multiple embedded activities, such as case briefs and article critiques in Overview of Teaching (EDU 202); critical analysis of practicum in Teaching Practicum (EDU 327); technology-integration activities in Integrating Technology in the Classroom (EDU 328); case studies in Educating Diverse and Exceptional Learners (EDU 335); teaching demonstrations in Teaching Reading (EDU 320); and assessment methods and analysis reports in Literacy Across the Disciplines (EDU 330). Although some syllabi mention HQIM, not all embed HQIM into course assignments. Children's Literature (EDU 324) and EDU 300 require lesson or unit plans, but these rely on candidate-constructed units rather than annotated lesson plans using provided standards and resources. Evidence of HQIM was not identified in several content-area courses, including Social Studies for the K-12 Classroom (EDU 306) and Teaching STEM in Elementary (EDU 340 and EDU 345). While Teaching Reading (EDU 320) and Children's Literature (EDU 324) incorporate SOR practices, Literacy Across the Disciplines (EDU 330) misses an opportunity to integrate SOR practices embedded within HQIM, despite the syllabi tracker indicating otherwise.

In the Coursework focus group, three of seven candidates provided examples of best practices in their coursework, including alignment to standards, use of textbooks, technology integration, and reflections. One candidate mentioned completing the SOR Pathway through professional development. Candidates did not provide explicit examples of HQIM use. Course instructors (n=4) described incorporating best practices and HQIM, with one noting that HQIM is introduced in Integrating Technology in the Classroom (EDU 328), including how to access materials digitally. HQIM resources for SOR are housed in a shared campus space. Courses such as Integrating the Liberal Arts (EDU 403) and Practicum offer opportunities for lesson development, but it is unclear whether candidates adapt HQIM materials or create lessons independently; instructors noted that Classic Literature is sometimes used in Practicum rather than HQIM.

In three of the four coursework observations, reviewers saw evidence of best practices. For example, in Teaching Practicum (EDU 327), students engaged in discussions and class sessions focused on the Danielson Framework and on documenting and analyzing classroom observations. In the observed session, the instructor reviewed previous Framework components and discussed alignment across planning processes. However, evidence of HQIM was not seen in three of the four observations.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development
MEETS

Coursework familiarizes candidates with the Arkansas K–12 Standards across all grade bands within the licensure area and provides some opportunities for vertically integrating standards. Teaching Practicum (EDU 327) requires two observation evaluations with written lesson plans scaffolded by the mentor. Integrating the Liberal Arts in K–12 (EDU 403) requires candidates to create five lessons aligned to the Arkansas curriculum standards. Integrating Technology in the Classroom (EDU 328) includes standards alignment as a key component of its rubric. Social Studies for the K–12 Classroom (EDU 306) requires ten lesson plans but does not specify which standards must be incorporated. Teaching Reading (EDU 320) requires reading lesson plans using structured literacy principles, though these principles and relevant standards are not explicitly identified. While many assignments require candidates to develop lessons or units, most syllabi do not specify which standards should serve as the foundation, nor whether candidates should create original plans, modify existing ones, or annotate provided materials. The lesson plan template, however, includes a designated space for Arkansas Academic Standards alignment.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=7) provided examples of how they used standards. One candidate referenced lesson planning and standards use in the Liberal Arts course; another noted standards being applied in core English coursework. Candidates described exposure to vertical alignment activities in Integrating Technology in the Classroom (EDU 328) and in Teaching PE/Health K–12, with one stating, “We look at more than one focus area.” Course instructors (n=4) also shared examples of how they use standards. All reported incorporating vertical alignment and continuity in learning, with one explaining, “We take standards, cut them up, and identify ‘need to know’ standards before the next grade level.” Instructors also noted that candidates use the same lesson plan template in Practicum and Residency, strengthening familiarity with the process.

In one coursework observation, reviewers saw explicit use of standards. In Teaching Practicum (EDU 327), students were provided the standards and instructed to use them in their mini-teach assignments.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher
APPROACHING

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses
APPROACHING

Courses are somewhat sequenced across the program of study to build on prior coursework and provide candidates opportunities to demonstrate proficiency. The curriculum shows an increase in documentation requirements, culminating in Residency I and II, though this does not necessarily reflect increased rigor. The transition to a year-long Residency allowed the EPP to restructure the course sequence so that topics and assignments are embedded within clinical practice. However, reinforcement activities for areas of candidate growth were not evident in the

documentation. Although an assessment data tracker has been created, how that data is used to support candidate growth is unclear.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=7) agreed that rigor increases from Overview of Teaching (EDU 202) through courses such as Educating Diverse and Exceptional Learners (EDU 335) and Integrating Technology in the Classroom (EDU 328). From Practicum to Residency, course requirements expand (e.g., more hours, increased observations, additional and more accurate lesson plans, and retaking assignments not passed). As one candidate noted, "As you move forward to an internship, they challenge you more." In the Course Instructor focus group (n=4), all instructors agreed that course sequence and progression are intentional, and that Residency has supported more meaningful discussions about embedding rigorous coursework within clinical practice. Consistent use of documentation forms, such as the lesson plan template, strengthens candidates' understanding and confidence.

Although curriculum development was referenced multiple times, documentation does not clearly show how this process increases rigor or expands candidates' exposure to the field. A "Glow and Grow" handout is provided to students, but no evidence was given regarding follow-up or how growth checks are monitored.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards to support candidates in developing the knowledge and skills required for their licensure area. All reviewed courses reference the Arkansas Educator Competencies, Arkansas Teaching Standards, and/or InTASC Standards.

Course instructors (n=4) reported that competencies and standards are noted in syllabi, posted on Canvas, and addressed during discussions related to ethics and the Danielson Framework. Instructors indicated that candidates are exposed to these competencies primarily through instructor modeling and lesson demonstrations (e.g., presenting objectives at the start of a lesson) rather than through explicit instruction.

In two of the five course observations, reviewers noted explicit discussion of standards and competencies. References to standards and competencies were also present in all five course syllabi.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience MEETS

Coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned to clinical experiences, as evidenced by observation-hour requirements across multiple syllabi. With the transition to a year-long Residency, the EPP has strategically sequenced courses to run concurrently with clinical practice, allowing candidates to connect classroom objectives with fieldwork. Candidates consistently have opportunities to reflect on these connections with their clinical supervisors and course instructors. Teaching Residency II (EDU 491), taken during the year-long Residency, explicitly asks candidates to make connections between prior coursework and their field experiences.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=7) agreed that coursework aligns with clinical experience. They shared examples of practicing lessons with peers, receiving feedback, and later implementing those lessons in the field. Candidates also described interdisciplinary connections in both coursework and clinical settings, as well as opportunities to teach peers in on-campus classes. In the Course Instructor focus group (n=4), instructors highlighted the culminating capstone project, which requires candidates to reflect on how coursework has informed their development. They also noted that the lesson plan template includes a reflective component, creating a feedback loop from one observation to the next. A weekly seminar during Residency provides additional time for reflection and sharing of field experiences. During Practicum, candidates write their philosophy of education based on their coursework and early clinical exposure. Assignments in the development course, as well as common assessments in core courses, incorporate application and reflection.

In two of the five course observations, reviewers observed strong alignment between coursework and clinical experience. In Development and Learning in the Classroom (EDU 467), the instructor emphasized making connections between class concepts and candidates' future teaching, stating, "the purpose of those is to help you make the connections between what we're seeing in the class...and what it means to you personally as a future teacher." Although many candidates had limited field experience at this point, the instructor encouraged them to "project and think of the future," reinforcing the intentional linkage between coursework and clinical practice.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Program documentation and observation evidence indicate that most course instructors demonstrate deep knowledge of Arkansas K–12 standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. All pedagogical coursework, with the exception of EDU 202, is taught by faculty who hold terminal degrees, and clinical coursework is facilitated by instructors with prior public school experience. The institution requires a master's degree or higher for all instructional faculty, ensuring a strong academic and professional foundation. Faculty resumes and training records show that most instructors have completed professional learning in HQIM, the Science of Reading (SoR), Phonics First, Coaching, AI integration, and the Aspiring Teacher Rubric.

In the teacher candidate focus group (n=6), all participants described their instructors as knowledgeable, accessible, and deeply invested in their learning. One candidate shared that her professor “has taught several grade levels and is always available to help in any way, academically or emotionally,” while another noted that faculty “answer every question, even if they need to research and follow up later.”

Faculty focus group participants reinforced this perception, highlighting ongoing partnerships with the local cooperative and the university's administrative support for training in evidence-based instructional practices. Several instructors referenced recent training in LETRS, Coaching, and HQIM, as well as SoR Awareness pathways, demonstrating engagement with current educational research and best practices. Observations of instruction further supported instructors' deep pedagogical understanding, particularly in lessons addressing cognitive development, memory, and instructional scaffolding. While one observed instructor relied on somewhat dated materials and did not consistently cite research sources, the overall instructional quality and conceptual grounding in learning theory reflected strong pedagogical skill.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors demonstrate strong facilitation skills and provide consistent feedback and support. Faculty evaluations and course surveys generally reflect positive perceptions of candidates. Culminating assignments—such as the Integrated Thematic Unit in Integrating the Liberal Arts in K–12 (EDU 403) and the Tech Integration Plan in Integrating Technology in the Classroom (EDU 328)—are scaffolded in smaller segments, so candidates receive feedback throughout the process. Teaching Practicum (EDU 327) offers feedback on lesson plans and classroom management plans, along with oral and written feedback from instructors and peers during teaching demonstrations. Candidates also rate videos using the Aspiring Teacher Rubric (ATR) and calibrate scores with instructors and peers, deepening their understanding of the rubric.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=7) praised both the quantity and quality of feedback. One shared, “It's definitely made me a stronger lesson planner, and even just a stronger future teacher.” Candidates noted that instructors not only facilitate class effectively but also provide opportunities for peer teaching, which prepares them for Residency. They described meaningful connections between theory and practice, confidence-building opportunities, and instructors who ask probing questions to support growth. Residents also submit lesson plans to the Residency Coordinator for ATR-aligned feedback. Faculty advisors were described as invested in candidates' futures, helping them pursue additional minors or endorsements. As one candidate stated, “They're great about thinking about your future...They'll help you with whatever you need...They are just very there for you.”

Reviewers observed some evidence of strong facilitation and coaching in coursework observations. In Development and Learning in the Classroom (EDU 467), the instructor facilitated class discussion with ease, responded appropriately to candidates' questions, and scaffolded collaborative conversations. The instructor also monitored candidate progress and emphasized creativity over practicality when problem-solving in a theoretical case.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

APPROACHING

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences is intentionally structured to build on prior learning and support candidate development. Documentation shows that the clinical sequence follows a gradual release model, providing opportunities for candidates to observe, participate, and eventually lead instruction. Clinical experiences begin with Early Observations, which include 20 hours of observation in EDU 202, 10 hours viewing curated teaching videos across grade bands, and 10 hours in an appropriate classroom. The sequence then progresses to the Teaching Practicum, which requires 30 hours of observation and participation in an assigned classroom. The final stage is the year-long Residency, consisting of 270 hours in semester one and 360 hours in semester two in an appropriate classroom with a qualified mentor teacher. Residents work with their mentor teacher to create an individualized plan and earn 15 credit hours. According to the Residency Handbook, candidates who complete all coursework and required professional development, pass licensure exams, and meet graduation requirements are recommended for licensure.

The candidate in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=1) reinforced the clear sequencing: "There is an overview of teaching, we go to a school and observe, and have a post observation to discuss. The next experience is a practicum and then an internship." Clinical supervisors (n=3) also affirmed the intentional progression, with one noting that they "use mini-teaches to build confidence."

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

APPROACHING

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides some opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs. Although documentation shows that candidates are placed in districts that vary in size, demographics, and socioeconomic status, there is no clear evidence that residents consistently engage with students who have diverse learning needs.

The candidate in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=1) shared that mentor teachers encouraged observation across multiple classrooms, but did not describe direct opportunities to work with students of differing abilities. Clinical supervisors (n=3) provided a few examples of exposure to varied needs, noting that "they all have opportunities to work with kids with varied needs" and that some assignments support this, while another supervisor mentioned that candidates may attend IEP meetings when appropriate. However, the evidence does not suggest that such experiences are intentionally coordinated or systematically embedded by the EPP.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

Experienced mentor teachers demonstrate the coaching skills needed to properly support and develop candidates. Documentation shows that mentors have multiple opportunities to provide feedback; however, no examples of feedback aligned to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric (ATR) were provided.

The candidate in the Clinical Experience focus group described the high quality of mentor questioning and feedback, noting that it led to meaningful improvements in their lesson: "She questions every single thing...It is just for me to grow."

In a course observation, reviewers noted strong coaching practices from the mentor teacher. The mentor asked probing questions about each part of the lesson, offered multiple instructional strategies for the candidate to consider, reinforced the use of standards as the focus of learning, used student data to guide scaffolded instruction, and encouraged appropriate pacing to ensure the lesson could be completed within the allotted time.

Note: By 2026–2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

A clear and intentional process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers. According to the handbook, “The mentor teacher should have at least three years of experience in the District and some education beyond the bachelor’s degree. The mentor teacher has the dual role of being responsible for the instructional program for pupils while serving as mentor for the resident.”

Participants in the School Partnership focus group (n=4) confirmed that they intentionally select teachers who meet DESE criteria, prioritizing those designated as Master or Lead teachers or who hold National Board Certification. One partner noted that selected mentors often have leadership experience within the school community, such as serving as grade-level or content leads or PLS leads.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors

MEETS

Program documents show that the EPP has clear requirements for clinical supervisors, including expectations outlined in the Residency Handbook and a supervisor information sheet documenting degrees, licensure, prior teaching experience, and required training. The Field Experience Supervisor conducts all formal observations and evaluations for practicum students and residents, and when needed, qualified full-time faculty members substitute to ensure continuity. Documentation confirms that the Field Experience Supervisor and two faculty members have completed all required supervision and coaching training, and that each has prior experience in field supervision, establishing a foundation for effective instructional support.

In the teacher candidate focus group (n=4), participants described consistent, meaningful, and responsive coaching interactions that contributed positively to their development. One candidate explained that they “meet once a week... go over the lesson plan, then later talk about how it went,” emphasizing that sessions included opportunities to raise personal questions, discuss challenges, and engage in reflective dialogue driven by the candidate’s needs. Another participant noted, “We use the whole time every single time. I’m always learning,” describing the supervisor’s approach as supportive and growth-oriented.

Observational evidence offered a mixed but overall positive picture of coaching practices. In one session, the supervisor affirmed the candidate’s effective use of literacy strategies within a science lesson and asked the candidate to explain her rationale for choral reading, which the candidate did with reference to evidence-based reasoning. The supervisor also prompted reflection on student engagement and discussed possible strategies to improve participation. While some coaching conversations showed limited depth—for example, relying on yes/no questions or not connecting feedback to ATR indicators—other interactions demonstrated targeted questioning and instructional guidance.

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates

MEETS

Candidates receive high-quality feedback that is linked to evidence of student learning during observed lessons and builds on prior feedback. Documentation showed use of the Aspiring Teacher Rubric (ATR); however, the rubric artifacts and corresponding lesson plans contained minimal feedback for reviewers to examine.

The candidate in the Clinical Experience focus group reported that feedback is frequent and generally high quality, noting that it is linked to student learning, though not always to student data: “We have classroom feedback. I submit my lesson plan, she reviews it, and we will talk about it. We use the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. I can email her anytime for feedback.”

Reviewers observed evidence of quality feedback in coaching observations. In one instance, reviewers observed the pre-conference and two post-conference conversations involving the clinical supervisor and mentor teacher. The team noted that the candidate received feedback—both written and oral—focused on improving instructional strategies, increasing student engagement, supporting mastery of standards, and pacing the lesson effectively. While written feedback explicitly referenced the ATR, coaching conversations did not. Reviewers also observed a clear link between the mentor teacher’s pre-observation feedback, evidence of student learning during the lesson, and the follow-up feedback provided.

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024–25 academic year.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

MEETS

Collaborative processes are in place with most districts and schools to co-construct the clinical internship, though documentation provides limited evidence of true collaboration. While emails show that partners were invited to meetings and given agendas, they do not clearly demonstrate how partners contributed to decision-making or planning.

Participants in the School Partners focus group (n=4) believed that mentors collaborate with the EPP and stated that they are included in conversations about mentor selection. One partner explained that the EPP sends a list of candidates needing placements along with background information to help determine appropriate mentor matches. Several partners emphasized that the partnership with the EPP is essential for filling vacant teaching positions, and many shared that they have hired candidates who completed their placements in their schools.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Collaborative processes are in place to support and develop effective clinical supervisors. Documentation indicates that clinical supervisors and faculty regularly participate in professional development, conferences, and training opportunities.

In the Clinical Supervisor focus group (n=3), one participant explained, “We continue to participate in PL and PLC leadership with partner schools. We figure out what we need to do better to put out the best product. We have a great relationship with our COOP and participate in training, including LETRS, Cognitive Coaching, and HQIM. The admin supports what we ask to do.”

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

Most candidates show proficiency in coursework requirements. The Candidate Data Tracker indicates that all candidates meet GPA expectations at each transition point, and all graduate with a GPA of 3.0 or higher, with an average GPA of 3.6.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

APPROACHING

Candidates are inconsistently provided individualized support plans when their coursework requirements are not on track. While candidates are monitored through the Candidate Data Tracker and performance on common

assessments, the documentation provided reflects only the residency experience, making it unclear how data are used to support candidates in coursework outside of Residency.

Participants in the Course Instructor focus group (n=4) described the campus-wide Early Alert System, which identifies students needing additional support. They also noted that GPA requirements help monitor progress throughout the program. Performance Improvement Plans are available when necessary, though the small size of the program often allows instructors to address concerns through informal, one-on-one conversations. Instructors reported using Grow and Glow documents to guide student goal-setting and track progress toward those goals.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

Programs have clear and appropriate goals and milestones for candidates' clinical internships, as shown in the Residency Overview, the Residency Performance Evaluation Timeline, the Common Assessment Data Tracker, the Field Experience Checklist, and the Portfolio and Completer Checklist. Documentation indicates that most candidates meet these clinical experience goals and milestones.

While program goals are communicated in handbooks, the candidate in the Clinical Experience focus group expressed uncertainty about the specific goals for clinical experience. Clinical supervisors identified GPA expectations, dispositions, and passing formal observations and assessments as key milestones for program completion. They noted that "100% of candidates will make it to graduation unless an improvement plan is in place."

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

APPROACHING

There is adequate evidence that candidates have the capacity to impact student growth, as demonstrated in the Lesson Plan Template, which includes opportunities for reflection on lesson performance. Additional evidence appears in the Unit Work Sample Guidelines and the Candidate Data on the Unit Work Sample.

The candidate in the Clinical Experience focus group described using formative assessments—such as circulating the classroom and asking questions—to check for understanding. They discussed reviewing assessment data with their mentor teacher. Clinical supervisors provided some examples of working with mentor teachers to assess student growth and support struggling students; however, one noted, "unless it's part of the data they bring, we don't have access to other data." Another shared that "the new assessment class will be specific to this, and it's paired with the residency."

In one coaching observation, reviewers observed potential impact on student growth. The candidate's lesson plan included accommodations for ELL students. During the post-conference, the mentor teacher recommended using comprehension test data from the previous week to modify discussion questions based on student understanding. However, reviewers noted that the candidate ran out of time and did not complete the exit ticket, and that there was no push to differentiate instruction for students with varied learning needs.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Most candidates receive an "Effective" rating on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric by the end of their clinical internship, as shown in the Frequency of Ratings in Formal Evaluations document. Seventy-three percent of candidates scored Effective or above on their first formal evaluation, and 81% scored Effective or above on their second formal evaluation.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

MEETS

All candidates with varied needs are provided with the support they require. The EPP uses Teacher Improvement Plans, and one example showed a detailed plan identifying the deficiency, outlining required actions, and including a

space for the candidate to sign and take ownership of their improvement. Additional documentation demonstrates communication to coordinate meetings and discuss next steps with the candidate. Evidence also showed that high-performing candidates receive recognition and opportunities that encourage retention, such as membership in the Kappa Delta Pi Honor Society and awards presented at Honors Day.

Clinical supervisors (n=3) reinforced the support process, explaining, “the first step is a conversation between the candidate and the mentor teacher. If we cannot make significant improvement quickly, we move to improvement plans—we want to see improvement quickly and by a certain date.” They also confirmed structures for recognizing high-performing candidates, noting, “we recognize interns with dinner, celebrate their strengths,” and describing end-of-year awards for elementary and secondary residents “who went above and beyond.”

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
BELOW	BELOW	MEETS
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: - Establish programmatic support to ensure that Traditional program completers are prepared to obtain standard licensure. (<i>Focus Area: Criteria 3.1a</i>) - Establish resources to help program completers to gain employment in Arkansas schools and pursue initiatives to encourage candidates to consider high-priority subject areas and work placements once licensed. (<i>Focus Area: Criteria 3.2a, 3.2b</i>)		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license

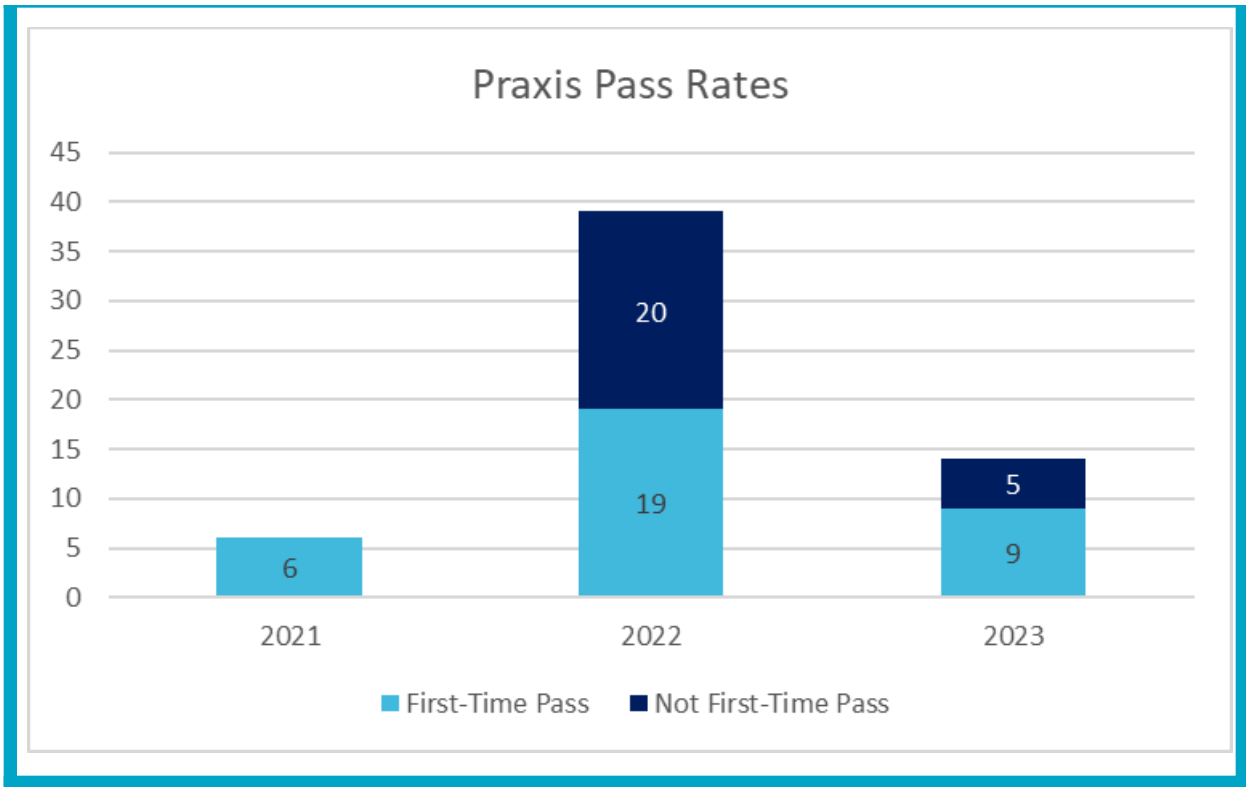
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license	80%	52%	BELOW

Licensure

Year	Licensed	Not Licensed
2021	3	4
2022	3	5
2023	5	1

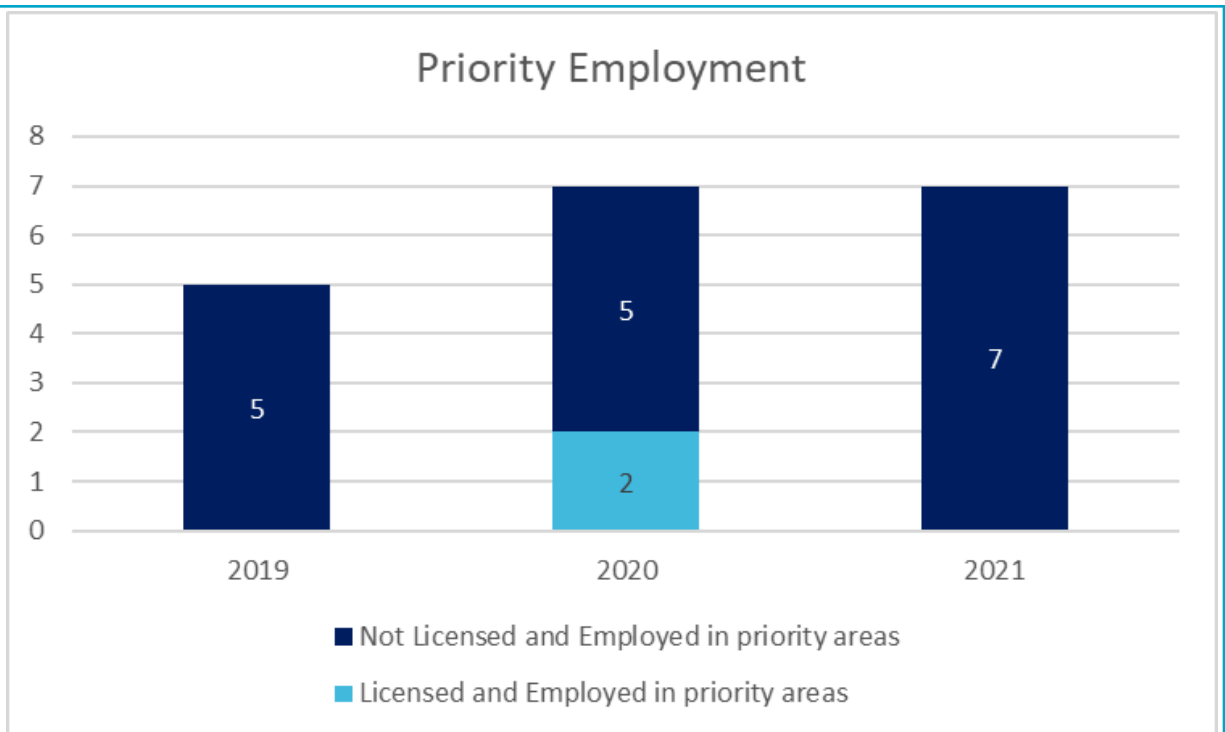
Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	73%	n/a	n/a

Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try			
Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	66%	58%	APPROACHING



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	68%	47%	BELOW												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and Employed</th><th>Not Licensed and Employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2019</td><td>1</td><td>4</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>5</td><td>2</td></tr><tr><td>2021</td><td>3</td><td>4</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and Employed	Not Licensed and Employed	2019	1	4	2020	5	2	2021	3	4
Year	Licensed and Employed	Not Licensed and Employed													
2019	1	4													
2020	5	2													
2021	3	4													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	39%	11%	BELOW												



*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

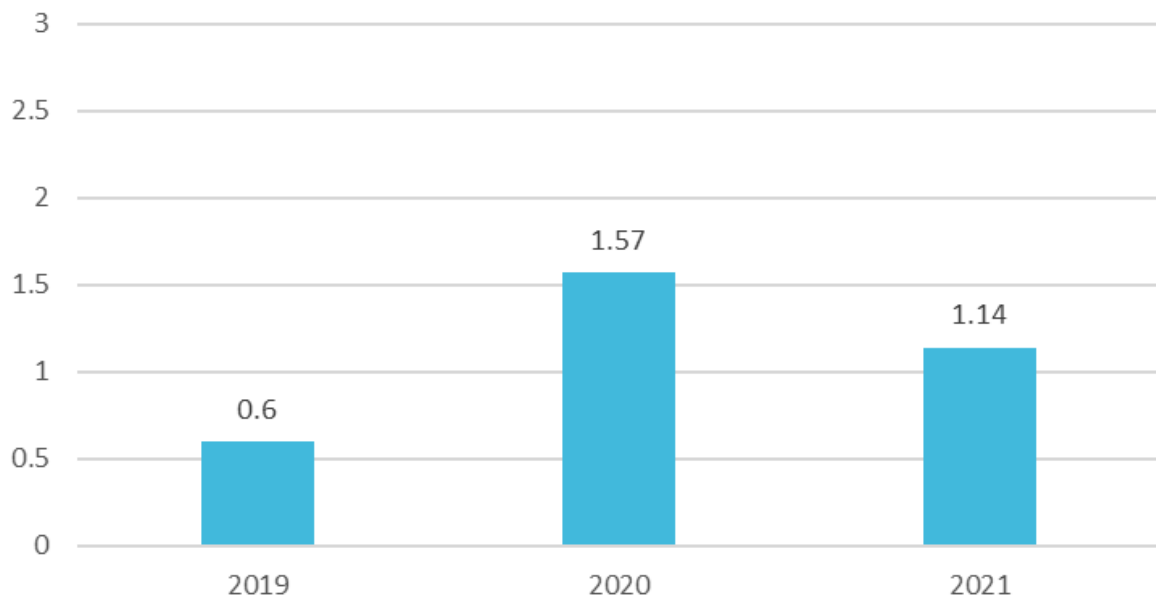
Current subject shortage areas for employment: Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.8	1.16	APPROACHING

Average Experience 3 Years After Completion



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	78%	80%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	79%	88%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	33%	APPROACHING

